

Panko Gains Fifth Spot In Batting Order

Despite his balky attitude during Spring training, Emil Panko, Yonkers' most promising minor league prospect, has apparently impressed manager Andy Cohen of the New Orleans Pelicans and that city's sportswriters. He impressed Cohen enough to win a starting berth in left field and the fifth batting position for the Southern Association club.

Buddy Diliberto, who covers the Pelicans for the Times-Picayune down there reports that Panko has proved himself a capable ball hawk and said, "Now, if he can hit as they say he can, he can and should be a regular all season."

In the former Saunders star's first attempt to hit Major League pitching, when his club met Detroit in an exhibition game last Monday, he failed to get a hit in three tries, but his club only managed one off Detroit's chucking. He did look impressive though in the outfield where he did some traveling to pull in all four flies hit out to him.

After being rained out Tuesday night, the Pelicans opened with a 5-3 win over Mobile last night. Another Yonkers product, Warren Melvin is umpiring the New Orleans-Mobile series.

A motorcade through the heart of New Orleans will greet Panko and the best of the Pelicans tomorrow when they make their home debut. Panko rejoined the team last week after flying home from their camp late last month.

Lona Makes 4th Try